Before you begin

Gambling: my story and my diary

Two parts to work on before your cohort begins: your story, and a daily diary. Print these pages, or copy the questions into a notebook that you keep for the whole programme. Write as much or as little as you like. Nothing needs to be shared.

Part 1: My story

1. When did you first gamble? How old were you, and what was happening in your life at the time?

2. Why did you start? Who was around you, and what did gambling give you then: excitement, escape, hope, belonging?

3. How has your gambling changed over the years? Think of times you gambled more, less, or stopped for a while, and what you gambled on.

4. What have you tried before to stop or cut down, and what did you learn from it?

5. What does gambling give you now? And what does it cost you: money, debt, time, sleep, relationships, trust, how you feel about yourself?

6. What has brought you to this group, now?

7. Who are you becoming? Describe yourself living free of gambling.

Part 2: My diary

Keep this diary every day until the cohort begins, and keep going as you go through the programme. You don't need to change anything yet: just notice. Write one line for each time you gambled, and for each strong urge, even if you didn't act on it.

Day 1 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

8. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

9. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

10. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

11. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 2 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

12. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

13. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

14. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

15. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 3 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

16. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

17. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

18. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

19. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 4 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

20. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

21. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

22. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

23. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 5 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

24. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

25. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

26. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

27. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 6 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

28. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

29. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

30. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

31. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Day 7 Date: _____

Time	What I bet on, and how much	Where (app, venue)	Alone, or with whom?	How I felt just before	Urge 0 to 10

32. How much time and money did I spend gambling today?

33. Which urges could I let pass? Which felt very hard to resist, and why?

34. When did the urges come: alone, late at night, after payday, during sport, on my phone, when stressed or bored?

35. What emotions sat underneath my gambling today? How did I feel after winning, and after losing?

Need more days? Print the diary pages again, or carry on in your notebook.